Pregnancy Frequently Asked Questions

Answers to common questions from your OB/GYN team at Women's Specialists of Clear Lake

PRENATAL CARE

Q: When should I schedule my first visit?
Schedule as soon as pregnancy is confirmed — ideally between **8–10 weeks**. We'll confirm the pregnancy, estimated due date, and start your care plan.

Q: How often will I be seen?
Monthly until 28 weeks · every 2 weeks 28–36 weeks · weekly 36–40 weeks · twice weekly after 40 weeks.

Q: What prenatal vitamins should I take?
Begin a prenatal vitamin with at least **400–800 mcg of folic acid** as soon as possible. Start before conception if planning a pregnancy.

DIET & NUTRITION

Q: How much extra should I eat?
Extra calorie needs: **0 extra in 1st trimester · ~340/day 2nd · ~450/day 3rd trimester**. Focus on nutrient quality, not just quantity.

Eat Plenty Of:
- Fruits, vegetables, whole grains
- Lean protein, legumes, dairy
- Low-mercury fish (salmon, tilapia, shrimp)

Avoid:
- Raw/undercooked meat, fish, eggs
- High-mercury fish (shark, swordfish)
- Unpasteurized products, deli meats
- Alcohol — no safe amount

MEDICATIONS & SAFETY

Q: What medications are safe?
Generally safe: Tylenol (acetaminophen), Tums, Zofran (with approval), prenatal vitamins. **Avoid NSAIDs** (ibuprofen, Advil) especially after 20 weeks.

Q: Can I exercise?
Yes! **30 minutes of moderate exercise** most days is recommended unless complications arise. Walking, swimming, and prenatal yoga are excellent choices.

Q: Can I travel?
Generally safe until 36 weeks. Avoid long trips after 28 weeks without medical clearance. Stay hydrated and move frequently on long trips.

PRENATAL VISIT SCHEDULE

8–10 wks	Confirm pregnancy, EDD, baseline labs, genetic counseling
11–14 wks	First trimester screen, NT ultrasound, NIPT if desired
16–18 wks	Quad screen, hear heartbeat, discuss anatomy scan
18–22 wks	Anatomy ultrasound — detailed fetal survey
24–28 wks	Gestational diabetes screen (1-hr glucose), Tdap
28–36 wks	Every 2 weeks; RhoGAM if Rh-negative
36–40 wks	Weekly; GBS swab; birth plan discussion
40+ wks	Twice weekly; NST; discuss induction options

WARNING SIGNS

Call Us Immediately / Go to L&D:
- Vaginal bleeding (any amount)
- Severe abdominal pain or cramping
- Signs of preeclampsia: severe headache, vision changes, swelling in face/hands
- Decreased fetal movement after 28 weeks
- Water breaking / gush of fluid
- Fever over 100.4°F
- Regular contractions before 37 weeks

After-hours emergency: Call our office or go directly to Clear Lake Regional Medical Center L&D

VACCINES IN PREGNANCY

Recommended & Safe:
- **Tdap:** 27–36 weeks (every pregnancy)
- **Flu vaccine:** Every flu season (any trimester)
- **COVID-19:** Recommended; discuss with Dr. Klein
- **RSV vaccine:** 32–36 weeks (Abrysvo) — protects newborn

Avoid Live Vaccines in Pregnancy:
- MMR, Varicella, Live flu mist, Yellow fever

Vaccines are the safest way to protect you and your newborn from serious illness.

Questions? We're Here for You 24/7

No question is too small. Call our office at **(281) 557-0300** during office hours. For after-hours emergencies, leave a message and our on-call provider will return your call. We're honored to be part of your pregnancy journey.